

# Troubleshooting Methodology — Guided Notes

Unit 5.1.1 | CompTIA Network+ N10-009 Obj. 5.1 | N10-008 5.1

Name: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_ Period: \_\_\_\_\_

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*Complete each question using the lesson reading. Write in the blank or answer in the space provided.*

## Question 1

List the CompTIA seven-step troubleshooting methodology in order.

1. \_\_\_\_\_
2. \_\_\_\_\_
3. \_\_\_\_\_
4. \_\_\_\_\_
5. \_\_\_\_\_
6. \_\_\_\_\_
7. \_\_\_\_\_

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## Question 2

Step 1 says to 'question the obvious.' Give an example of an obvious check that resolves a surprising number of network tickets — and explain why it's easy to skip.

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## Question 3

Why is Step 3 (test the theory) separated from Step 5 (implement the solution)? What mistake happens when a technician combines testing and implementing?

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## Question 4

Step 4 requires establishing a plan before implementing. A good plan includes: the action to take, the expected \_\_\_\_\_, what to check to confirm success, and a \_\_\_\_\_ plan if the change doesn't work.

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## Question 5

Bottom-up troubleshooting starts at Layer \_\_\_\_\_ and works upward. This approach guarantees you don't miss a lower-layer problem masquerading as a higher-layer issue. The tradeoff is \_\_\_\_\_ — it checks many layers before reaching the actual problem.

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#### Question 6

Divide-and-conquer troubleshooting typically starts at Layer \_\_\_\_\_. If the device can ping its \_\_\_\_\_ successfully, you know Layers 1-3 are likely working and you focus upward. If not, you focus downward.

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#### Question 7

Step 7 — documentation — is often skipped. Name two concrete negative outcomes that happen when documentation is absent from the troubleshooting process.

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#### Question 8 — Real World Application

REAL WORLD: A tech gets a ticket that second-floor users can't reach the internet. They assume it's the uplink cable (same problem last week), swap it, and leave. Fifteen minutes later, the ticket reopens. Identify which step they skipped and what the correct process would have revealed.

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*Download the answer key from the class server:*

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wget http://[SERVER]/resources/network-engineer/5-1-1-troubleshooting-methodology/5-1-1-troubleshooting-methodology-answer-key.pdf
```